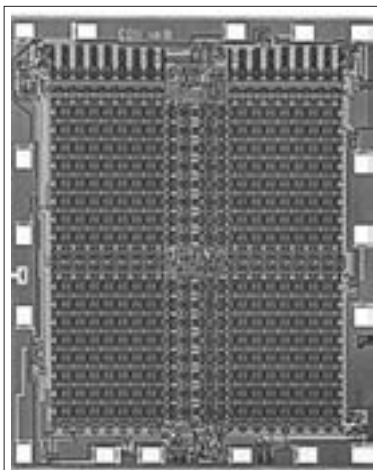


July: PARC is founded

Xerox Corporation brought together a team of world-class physics and information sciences researchers to found a now-world-famous entity—the Palo Alto Research Center (PARC): a research centre where many groundbreaking technologies and ideas have sprouted—such as laser printing, the graphical user interface, Ethernet, object-oriented programming, distributed computing, and ubiquitous computing.



Dynamic RAM, though expensive, created a stir in the market

In addition, many innovations have been inspired by the research at PARC. For instance, Steve Jobs once visited the place, and was impressed by the graphical user interface and mouse used on the Alto Computer (a PARC innovation). He visited it later in 1979 (after he'd bought a stake in Xerox), and that was inspiration enough for the Apple Lisa released in 1983, and also the Macintosh, released in 1984.

Xerox, unfortunately, was unable to market the best of what PARC produced—apart from laser printing technology. The Center continues to make breakthrough innovations in the fields of computing and information science.

December: One more step for networking

ALOHAnet was developed by Norman Abrahamson at the University of Hawaii. Based on HAM radio, all computers in the various centres in the university were linked. The nature of data transmission was haphazard since the Ham radio network was created such that a piece of data, unless received by the original